

## AMBASSADEHOTELLUCASEDIT

First up, we visit one of the most unique hotels in central Amsterdam, the Ambasad Hotel, right in the center of this gorgeous European city. Travel Radio Australia, and we're in Amsterdam at a very special place in Amsterdam. It's the Ambasad Hotel, and I'm with the managing director here, Lucas Schopman, and he's gonna tell us all about this fabulous place.

If you are coming to Amsterdam from anywhere in the world, this is the place to stay. Lucas, welcome to the program. Thank you very much, Jeff.

Very nice that you're having us. And Lucas, this place is so unique because it's not like one building. Here on the Herencracht, you've got a number of buildings all connected into one hotel.

Can you tell us how that works? That's correct. The hotel comprises over 12 canal buildings. We have two buildings on the single canal.

It's interconnected to the Herencracht, where our main entrance is located. We have 56 hotel rooms, and they're all unique. So it's a boutique hotel, a kind of avant la lettre.

So you have a nice canal view over one of the most beautiful canals here in Amsterdam, and every room is different. So we have different hotel room types. We have an apartment, several suites, and very nice deluxe rooms.

We're in the higher segment here in Amsterdam, but yeah, it feels like a home away from home. It's a unique experience where you can really experience how it is to live on a canal. That's the key to this.

It's not like a boring square box. They're real Amsterdam houses, and your position here is probably one of the best positions you can possibly get in Amsterdam because you're close to everything. Yeah, the hotel, it's unique in that sense that it has really character.

It was started in 1953, and we started with only two canal houses, and nowadays it's 12 canal houses. So it has been gradually been built, and you really feel that character. You can never copy it again.

And we have that culture and art is a big part of our formula. So we have a big Cobra art collection that comprises over 800 original works of art, and every hotel room is decorated based on one of the original artworks. And we have a unique library, which is also our library bar where we're sitting now, which houses over 6,000 signed copies of all the first edition books of the authors that stayed with us.

So whenever a author publishes a book in Dutch, they are usually staying with us. That's really great. And sitting here is such a lovely atmosphere.

You have chess sets and draft sets, and people can come in here and just relax. And like you say, you have a full bar here in the library, which is very unusual for Amsterdam. And tell us about some of the people who stay with you.

I believe you've had some major celebrities staying here. Yes, that's correct. So a lot of movie directors, big name authors.

We've had all the Nobel Prize winners, except for Bob Dylan, who hasn't stayed with us. But yeah, so many big names. And we invite everybody also.

If you're not staying with us, just to come in and experience our library or our beautiful restaurant, which is housed upstairs, and I'll show you later. We have a very nice restaurant overlooking the canal, proper service, but we intended to be more like a bistro or brasserie, so nice French-style brasserie, which allows people to just have a casual dining experience while overlooking the canals at night. And things also, you can organize all their tours too, all the guest tours, and I mean, I'm doing a couple for you as well around Amsterdam.

And tell us about some of those tours that are available. Well, we have, of course, all the boat, the canal boats that we offer. We have private walking tours.

We have art and literature tours. We have lovely tours if you're into live music. And of course, you can also help us with those tours.

And yeah, just guest service in general is what we pride ourselves in, so whatever the guest likes. Also, if you want to see more of the countries, we see the flower exhibition or see the Zaanse Schans, which are all the Dutch mills, and we offer all those tours. They're making some lovely coffees in the back here.

That's what that noise is, in case you're wondering, but that's okay. The thing is, speaking of the flower market, you're just up the street. If people want to visit the Amsterdam flower market, it's just literally two minutes away.

Yes, that's correct. We're in the center. If you're looking out the window, you can see the Dam Square, our royal palace.

You see the boats driving by because it was one of the nicest canal houses that we have. And of course, popular destinations like the Anne Frank House, Rijksmuseum, or even the flower market are all in walking distance. Yes, and the Jordaan is just around the corner, and basically, you're in the best spot in Amsterdam you could possibly get.

And tell us a bit about your background, Lucas. How did you end up here at the Ambasad? Well, I studied hospitality management in The Hague, and I've worked in several bigger hotels here in the city or also abroad. I worked in Brussels.

I worked in Spain. I set up a few restaurants, and then I got this really cool job with Earthwater, which is a lovely mineral water brand. And I got to see the whole country as their sales manager.

And then in 2015, the call came, would you like to set up the bar and the brasserie that we have here in the hotel? So that was almost 10 years ago. And yeah, since then, we've been expanding our product and our operations. So it grew bigger and bigger.

We have over a hundred staff members now, so yeah. Then I gradually moved up, and now I'm the crowd managing director together with our team. And yeah, very, very happy to work in such a beautiful location where art and culture is at such a high standing.

Yes, it certainly is. And a couple of your favorite places in Amsterdam to hang out at for people coming here, if they're staying at the hotel, what would you recommend? Well, Amsterdam is such a lively city, of course. It's got so much history.

So I would definitely advise people to contact us and hire a guide to do a nice walking tour because then they can really tell you all about the history and the little interesting facts that you find along the canals and all hidden in these little streets. And nowadays, Amsterdam is growing. So also the suburbs are getting more and more interesting.

So they all have their own little city centers, so to say. So not just the center is interesting. We've got some lovely musea that you need to visit, but also some upcoming boroughs like Amsterdam North are really interesting.

There's a lot of street art, big street art movement. It's really interesting. A lot of nice Dutch old brown bars that are really worth visiting.

And of course, if you're into music, then we've got some of the oldest pop temples here in town. So yeah, there's a bit for everybody. Good gastronomy, a lot of nice restaurants to visit.

And yeah, especially in spring or summertime, yeah, do a boat tour. And the city opens up so nice with all the parks and all the beautiful rooftop terraces and everything. And definitely worth hiring a bike if you're coming just to ride around and be like an Amsterdam local.

Yeah, yeah, be careful when you ride your bike. It can be quite dangerous, but yeah, I don't know, that's the best way, best form of transportation. Everybody rides their bikes here.

So yeah, no need for a car. Exactly, now how can people find out more about the Ambasad Hotel online, Lucas? Well, of course, I invite them to check out our website. It's [ambasad-hotel.nl](http://ambasad-hotel.nl), where you can find everything, all of the services that we provide.

Yeah, that's the easiest way to get in touch with us. We have a chat bot where you can have a direct chat with our guest service agents. And besides the hotel, we also offer a floating and massage center, which is the perfect way of relaxing.

So even if you're not staying with us, then you're always welcome to enjoy our services and see our hotel. So we're happy to show you around our lovely paintings and book collection. Wonderful, Lucas Schotman, who's the managing director of the Ambasad Hotel here in Amsterdam.

Thank you very much for being with us on Travel Radio Australia. And can you say hello in Dutch to our friends in Australia, who, we have a lot of Dutch people who live there, who are thinking of coming over. Yeah, thank you, Geoff.

It was a big pleasure being here on the show. And for all the Dutch listeners in Australia, you are very welcome to come to Amsterdam. And you can personally ask Lucas, and I invite you to come and see the Ambasad Hotel.

Ambasad Hotel, definitely highly recommended here in Amsterdam.